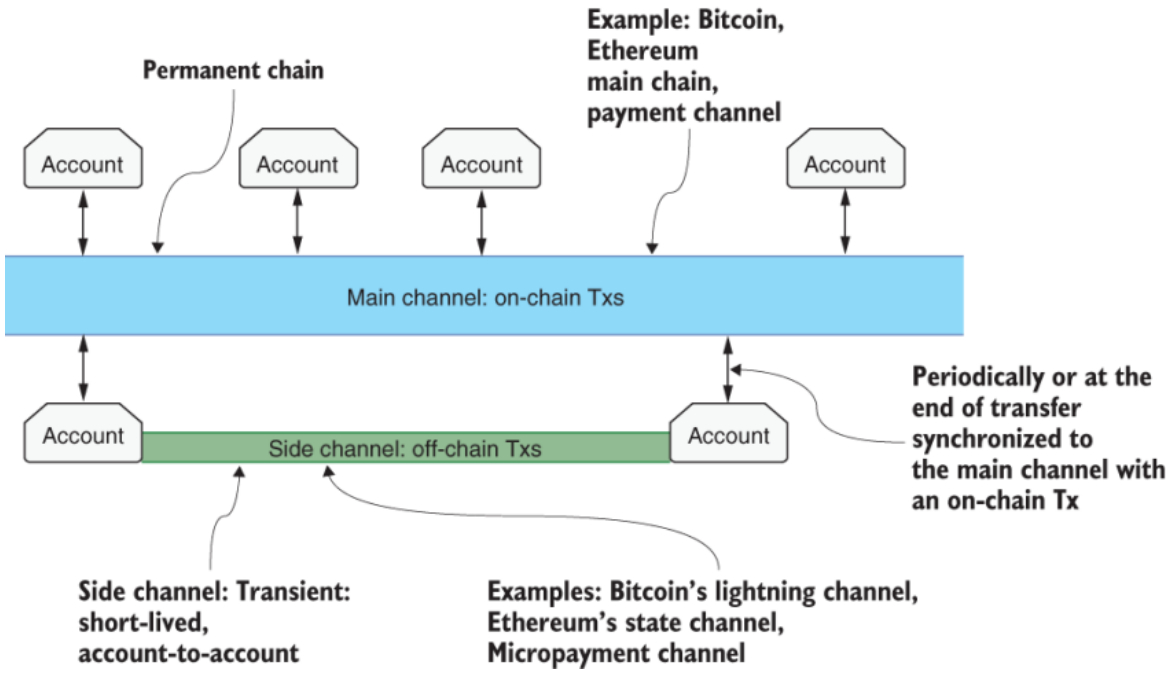


Figure 7.4 Relationship between the main channel and micropayment channel

7.4 Micropayment channel use case

To motivate the micropayment channel, let's consider a real-world problem: recyclable plastics on the earth. No country is immune to this problem, which is affecting ecosystems in the ocean and on land, including forests and rivers. It is simply impossible for any single organization, such as the United Nations, to send people to clean up all the countries in the world. Even if UN-like nongovernmental organizations provide funds, it is cost-effective for locals to do the cleanup. So this problem is a perfect decentralized problem: it has global scope, and participants are decentralized and not necessarily known to one another. Let's examine how blockchain can help solve this